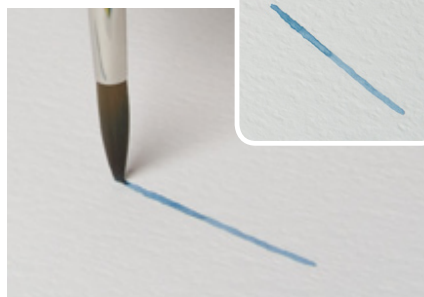


BRUSHSTROKES

Watercolor brushstrokes should be smooth and flowing. Practice relaxing your hand and wrist so that you can make continuous strokes, letting the brush do the work. Try using the brush at

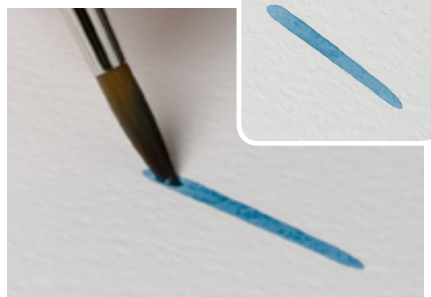
different angles and speeds. All the brushstrokes below were made with a No. 14. It is a good idea to use a large brush for as long as possible in your paintings to avoid creating fussy brushmarks.

Upright brush



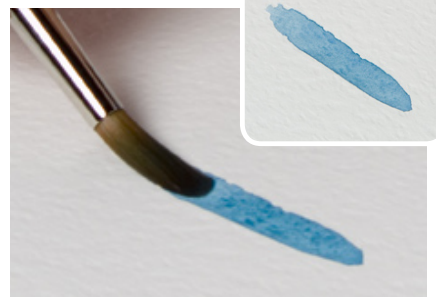
To make the thinnest possible line, hold the brush upright and only use the point.

Slanting brush



To create a medium-width line, lower the angle of the brush to use the center of the hairs.

Low brush



To produce the widest possible mark, press down so that you are using the full width of the brush.

Varying strokes

To create a long, solid stroke, move the brush slowly over the paper, letting the paint flow.



To make a fine, continuous line, hold the brush upright and just use the tip.



To make a petal-like mark, press the whole shape of the hairs down onto the paper.



To gradually lighten a mark, slowly lift off the brush as you move across the paper.



To create a broken, textured effect, drag the side of the brush quickly over the paper.



To make an expressive mark, speed up. Fast strokes are often straighter than slow ones.



To produce an undulating stroke, twist the brush rhythmically as you draw it across the paper.



To create this pattern, vary the pressure of your stroke as you cross the paper.

